



PROFESSIONAL SKILLS FOR ENGINEERS 25LPS101

QUESTION BANK

UNIT-1

SHORT QUESTIONS

1. Why are nouns and main verbs considered essential parts of sentence structure?

Nouns and main verbs are essential because they form the core of a sentence.

Nouns identify the subject (who or what the sentence is about).

Main verbs show the action or state of being of the subject.
Without either, a sentence cannot convey complete meaning.
Example: "The boy (noun) runs (main verb)."

2. How do nouns function as the object in a sentence? Give an example.

A noun functions as an **object** when it receives the action of the verb.

Example: "She reads **books**."

Here, "books" is the **object** receiving the action of reading.

3. Explain the degrees of comparison of adjectives. How are they formed and used correctly in sentences?

Adjectives can show **comparison** in three degrees:

Positive: describes one thing (big, beautiful)

Comparative: compares two things (bigger, more beautiful)

Superlative: compares more than two things (biggest, most beautiful)

Example:

Positive: "This house is **big**."

Comparative: "This house is **bigger** than that one."

Superlative: "This is the **biggest** house in the area."

4. What are articles? Explain the difference between definite and indefinite articles with examples.

Articles are words used before nouns to indicate specificity.

Definite article: “the” (refers to a specific noun)

Example: “I saw **the** dog in the park.”

Indefinite articles: “a” and “an” (refer to any one of a class)

Example: “I saw **a** dog in the park.”

5. What are irregular verbs? Explain how they differ from regular verbs with suitable example.

Irregular verbs do not follow the standard rule of adding -ed for the past tense.

Example: “go → went,” “see → saw”

Regular verbs form past tense by adding -ed.

Example: “walk → walked”

6. What is a noun? Give two examples.

A **noun** is a word that names a person, place, thing, or idea.

Examples: “teacher,” “city”

7. Define a proper noun and write two examples.

A **proper noun** names a specific person, place, or organization and is always capitalized.

Examples: “Odisha,” “Albert Einstein”

8. What is a common noun? How is it different from a proper noun?

A **common noun** is a general name for a person, place, or thing.

Difference: Proper nouns are specific and capitalized; common nouns are general.

Examples: “city” (common noun) vs. “Cuttack” (proper noun)

LONG ANSWERS

1. Explain the concept of nouns in English grammar. Discuss the different types of nouns with suitable examples. How do nouns function as the subject or object in a sentence?

Noun: A word that names a person, place, thing, or idea.

Types of nouns:

Proper Noun: Specific names (Gujarat, Shakespeare)

Common Noun: General names (city, teacher)

Collective Noun: Names a group (team, flock)

Abstract Noun: Names an idea or quality (freedom, happiness)

Concrete Noun: Names a tangible thing (book, apple)

Function in a sentence:

Subject: The noun performs the action.

Example: “**The teacher** teaches English.”

Object: The noun receives the action.

Example: “The student reads **a book**.”

2. What is a main verb? Describe its role in expressing the action or state of being in a sentence. Give examples to show the difference between main verbs and helping verbs.

Main verb: Shows the main action or state of the subject.

Examples: “run,” “eat,” “is,” “seem”

Helping verbs: Assist the main verb to form tense, mood, or voice.

Example:

Main verb alone: “She **runs** fast.”

With helping verb: “She **is running** fast.”

3. How do modifiers improve the clarity and meaning of a sentence? Illustrate your answer with examples showing correct and misplaced modifiers.

Modifiers are words or phrases that describe or give more information about another word. They improve clarity and detail.

Correct: “She wore a **red dress** to the party.”

Misplaced: “She wore a dress to the party that was **red**.” (unclear)

4. What is an adjective? Discuss its types (such as descriptive, quantitative, demonstrative, possessive, and interrogative adjectives) with examples.

Adjective: A word that describes or qualifies a noun.

Types:

Descriptive: Describes quality (beautiful, tall)

Quantitative: Shows quantity (some, few)

Demonstrative: Points out specific nouns (this, those)

Possessive: Shows ownership (my, his)

Interrogative: Used in questions (which, what)

5. Describe the rules for forming the past tense of regular verbs ending with -e, -y, and consonants. Illustrate with examples.

Ending in -e: Add -d → “love → loved”

Ending in -y preceded by consonant: Change y to i and add -ed → “study → studied”

Ending in consonant (not -y): Add -ed → “walk → walked”

6. Explain the concept of nouns in English grammar. Discuss the different types of nouns with suitable examples. How do nouns function as the subject or object in a sentence?

(This is similar to Q1 long; see answer above.)

7. Define pronouns and explain their role in replacing nouns. Discuss the different types of pronouns (personal, possessive, reflexive, demonstrative, interrogative, relative, and indefinite) with examples.

Pronouns: Words used to replace nouns to avoid repetition.

Types:

Personal: I, you, he, she, it, we, they

Possessive: mine, yours, his, hers, ours, theirs

Reflexive: myself, yourself, himself, herself

Demonstrative: this, that, these, those

Interrogative: who, which, what

Relative: who, which, that

Indefinite: someone, anyone, everybody

Example: “**Sita** loves painting → **She** loves painting.”

8. Discuss the rules of noun-pronoun agreement with respect to number, gender, and person. Illustrate your answer with suitable examples where incorrect agreement can change the meaning of a sentence.

Number: Singular noun → singular pronoun; plural noun → plural pronoun

Correct: “The boy lost **his** book.”

Incorrect: “The boy lost **their** book.”

Gender: Masculine, feminine, neutral pronouns must match nouns

Correct: “Ramesh said **he** will come.”

Person: First, second, third-person agreement should match

Correct: “I love my school.”

Incorrect: “I love his school.”

9. Examine the differences between proper nouns, common nouns, collective nouns, and abstract nouns. How can the choice of noun affect clarity and precision in writing? Provide examples in each case.

Proper Noun: Names a specific entity → “Cuttack”

Common Noun: General name → “city”

Collective Noun: Group → “team”

Abstract Noun: Idea/quality → “freedom”

Clarity: Choosing the correct noun ensures the reader understands exactly what is being referred to.

Example: “A teacher (common) taught the class” vs. “Mrs. Mishra (proper) taught the class.”

10. Explain the importance of pronouns in avoiding repetition in writing. Create sentences showing incorrect and correct usage of pronouns and explain the changes needed to improve clarity and grammatical accuracy.

Pronouns **replace nouns** to avoid repetition and make sentences smoother.

Incorrect: “Ramesh likes Ramesh’s book because Ramesh thinks Ramesh is interesting.”

Correct: “Ramesh likes **his** book because **he** thinks it is interesting.”

Change needed: Replace repeated nouns with appropriate pronouns for clarity and conciseness.

UNIT-2

SHORT ANSWERS

1. What are dangling modifiers? Explain how they cause confusion in sentences.

A **dangling modifier** is a word or phrase that describes something not clearly stated in the sentence. It “dangling” because it is not clearly attached to the word it is meant to modify. This can create confusion or a humorous misinterpretation.

Example:

Incorrect: *Running to catch the bus, the rain started pouring.*
(It seems the rain is running, which is confusing.)

Correct: *Running to catch the bus, I got soaked in the rain.*

Dangling modifiers cause confusion because the reader cannot immediately understand what is being described.

2. Describe the rules for using articles before nouns that begin with vowels and consonants.

Use “**a**” before words that start with a consonant sound.

Example: *a book, a university* (note: “university” starts with a “yoo” sound, which is a consonant sound).

Use “**an**” before words that start with a vowel sound.

Example: *an apple, an hour* (note: “hour” starts with a silent “h,” so the vowel sound “o” is pronounced).

Key point: The article depends on the **sound**, not just the first letter.

3. What are irregular verbs? Explain how they differ from regular verbs with suitable examples.

Regular verbs form the past tense and past participle by adding **-ed**.

Example: *walk → walked → walked*

Irregular verbs do **not** follow this pattern; they change form in unique ways.

Example: *go → went → gone, eat → ate → eaten*

The difference is in how the past tense and past participle are formed.

4. What is the difference between a noun and a verb? Give examples.

Noun: Names a person, place, thing, or idea.

Example: *book, teacher, city, happiness*

Verb: Shows an action or state of being.

Example: *run, eat, is, seem*

Sentence example: *The teacher (noun) runs (verb) every morning.*

5. Give two examples of homophones and use them in sentences.

Pair 1: *bare / bear*

to/two, Cell/Sell, Weather/Whether, write/right

I walked on the bare floor.

A bear appeared in the forest.

Pair 2: *sea / see*

We swam in the sea.

I see a bird on the tree.

Homophones are words that **sound the same but have different meanings and spellings.**

6. Give an example of a word that is both a noun and a verb (homonym).

Word: *book*

Noun: *I read a book.*

Verb: *I need to book a ticket.*

Homonyms are words that **have the same spelling (and sometimes pronunciation) but different meanings.**

7. Write a pair of homophones related to weather.

Pair: *rain / reign*

The rain stopped in the evening.

The king began his reign.

8. What are homonyms? Give one pair as an example.

Definition: Homonyms are words that **have the same spelling or pronunciation but different meanings.**

Example: *bat*

I saw a bat flying in the night. (noun: animal)

He will bat in the cricket match. (verb: play cricket)

LONG ANSWERS

1. Explain the concept of modifiers in English grammar. Discuss how adjectives and adverbs function as modifiers with suitable examples.

Modifiers are words, phrases, or clauses that **describe, limit, or qualify** another word in a sentence, making the meaning more specific or detailed.

Adjectives modify **nouns or pronouns**.

Example: *The **beautiful** garden is blooming.*

Adverbs modify **verbs, adjectives, or other adverbs**, giving more detail about manner, time, place, frequency, or degree.

Example: *She runs **quickly**.* (modifying the verb “runs”)

Example: *He is **very** talented.* (modifying the adjective “talented”)

2. Describe adjectives in detail. Explain their types, functions, and how they modify nouns. Support your answer with examples.

Adjectives describe or limit nouns and pronouns. They answer questions like: *Which one? What kind? How many?*

Types of adjectives:

Descriptive adjectives: Describe qualities of a noun.

*beautiful, tall, happy → She has a **happy** smile.*

Quantitative adjectives: Indicate quantity or amount.

*some, many, few → I have **few** friends.*

Demonstrative adjectives: Point out specific nouns.

*this, that, these, those → I like **this** book.*

Possessive adjectives: Show ownership.

my, your, his → **My** pen is red.

Interrogative adjectives: Used in questions.

which, what, whose → **Which** dress is yours?

Articles: 'a,' 'an,' and 'the' act as adjectives to define nouns.

I saw a cat.

Functions:

Adjectives usually **come before nouns** (*a tall man*) or **after linking verbs** (*The man is tall*).

3. Discuss the three degrees of comparison of adjectives. Explain how positive, comparative, and superlative degrees are formed and used.

Degrees of comparison express different levels of a quality.

Positive degree: Describes a single noun without comparison.

She is smart.

Comparative degree: Compares two nouns, often formed by adding **-er** or using **more**.

She is smarter than her brother.

He is more intelligent than his friend.

Superlative degree: Compares three or more nouns, usually by adding **-est** or using **most**.

She is the smartest in the class.

He is the most intelligent student.

Formation rules:

Short adjectives (1 syllable): add **-er/-est** → *tall* → *taller* → *tallest*

Long adjectives (2+ syllables): use **more/most** → *beautiful* → *more beautiful* → *most beautiful*

4. Explain adverbs and describe the major types of adverbs such as manner, place, time, frequency, and degree, with examples.

Adverbs describe **how, when, where, how often, or to what degree** an action occurs.

Types of adverbs:

Manner: How something is done → *quickly, carefully* → *She runs **quickly***

Place: Where → *here, there, everywhere* → *He looked **everywhere***

Time: When → *now, yesterday, soon* → *I will call you **tomorrow***

Frequency: How often → *always, often, never* → *She **always** wakes up early.*

Degree: Intensity or level → *very, too, extremely* → *It is **very** hot today.*

5. Discuss the placement of adverbs in English sentences. Explain how wrong placement changes the meaning, with suitable examples.

Placement rules:

Adverbs of **manner** usually follow the main verb: *He speaks **softly***

Adverbs of **frequency** usually precede the main verb: *She **always** arrives on time*

Adverbs of **time/place** often go at the end: *I will meet you **tomorrow** / **there***

Incorrect placement changes meaning:

Only she eats vegetables. → Implies nobody else eats vegetables.

She eats only vegetables. → Implies she eats nothing but vegetables.

6. Explain the degrees of comparison in adjectives (positive, comparative, and superlative). How are regular and irregular adjectives compared? Give examples showing correct usage in sentences.

Regular adjectives: Form comparative and superlative with **-er/-est** or **more/most** → *fast* → *faster* → *fastest*

Irregular adjectives: Have unique forms → *good* → *better* → *best*, *bad* → *worse* → *worst*

Examples:

Positive: This book is **good**.

Comparative: This book is **better** than that one.

Superlative: This is the **best** book I have ever read.

7. Discuss the role of adverbs in modifying verbs, adjectives, and other adverbs. Explain the different types of adverbs (manner, place, time, frequency, degree, etc.) with suitable examples.

Adverbs modify:

Verbs: *She sings beautifully*

Adjectives: *He is very talented*

Other adverbs: *She runs incredibly fast*

Types (with examples):

Manner → quickly, slowly

Place → here, there

Time → now, recently

Frequency → always, seldom

Degree → very, extremely

8. Examine the differences between adjectives and adverbs. Create sentences where incorrect use of adjectives or adverbs changes the meaning of a sentence, and explain the corrections needed.

Difference:

Adjectives modify nouns → *beautiful girl*

Adverbs modify verbs, adjectives, or adverbs → *runs beautifully*

Incorrect example:

She runs beautiful. (Wrong) → “beautiful” is an adjective; it should be an adverb.

Correction: *She runs beautifully.*

He is quick. (Correct) → “quick” describes a noun (He)

He runs quick. (Less formal; better: *He runs quickly*)

9. Analyze the impact of misplaced or dangling modifiers on sentence meaning. Rewrite sentences with misplaced modifiers to improve clarity, and explain the grammatical rules applied.

Misplaced modifier: *She almost drove her kids to school every day.* → “almost” seems to modify “drove”

Correction: *She drove her kids to school almost every day.*

Dangling modifier: *Walking to the park, the sun was shining.* → Incorrect; it sounds like the sun is walking.

Correction: *Walking to the park, I enjoyed the shining sun.*

Rule: Place modifiers **next to the word they are intended to describe**.

10. Explain how adjectives and adverbs can be used to enhance descriptive writing. Provide examples of simple sentences and show how they can be expanded using appropriate adjectives, adverbs, and modifiers for better expression.

Simple sentence: *The dog ran.*

Enhanced with adjectives and adverbs: *The **small, brown** dog ran **quickly** across the **sunny, green** park.*

Adjectives add detail about nouns (*small, brown, sunny, green*).

Adverbs add detail about verbs (*quickly*)

Modifiers make writing **vivid and precise**, improving clarity and imagery

UNIT-3

SHORT ANSWERS

1. What are finite and non-finite verbs? Give suitable examples.

Finite verbs show **tense, number, and person**; they function as the main verb in a clause.

*She **writes** a letter.* (shows tense)

*They **were playing**.*

Non-finite verbs do **not** show tense; they remain the same regardless of subject or time. They include **infinitives, gerunds, and participles**.

*I like **to read**.* (infinitive)

***Reading** books is fun.* (gerund)

*The **broken** glass was on the floor.* (participle)

2. Discuss the types of subordinate clauses (noun, adjective, adverb) with examples.

Noun Clause: Functions as a **subject, object, or complement**.

*I know **that she is honest**.*

Adjective Clause: Describes a noun; begins with **who, whom, which, that**.

*The book **that you gave me** is interesting.*

Adverb Clause: Modifies a verb/adjective/adverb; shows **time, reason, condition, contrast** etc.

*She left **because she was tired**.*

3. Identify the emotion conveyed by each interjection: Oops!, Yippee!, Ouch!

Oops! → Mistake or minor accident

Yippee! → Joy or excitement

Ouch! → Sudden pain

4. Compare and contrast simple present and simple past in terms of meaning and use.

Simple Present

Shows **habitual actions, general truths, or daily routines**.

*She **walks** to school every day.*

Simple Past

Shows an action **completed in the past**.

*She **walked** to school yesterday.*

Difference

Present = regular or current

Past = happened once or regularly in the past but no longer continues

5. What is Clause and write the types of clause with examples?

A **clause** is a group of words that contains a **subject and a verb**.

Types:

Independent/Main Clause: Can stand alone.

She smiled.

Dependent/Subordinate Clause: Cannot stand alone.

Because she was happy...

(Dependent clauses include **noun, adjective, adverb clauses.**)

6. What do you mean by subject–verb agreement?

Subject–verb agreement means that the **verb must match the subject in number and person.**

Singular subject → singular verb

Plural subject → plural verb

Example: *She* **plays.**, *They* **play.**

7. Give two examples where a singular subject takes a singular verb.

The boy **runs** *fast.*

My sister **is** *at home.*

8. Write one rule of subject–verb agreement with an example.

Rule:

When subjects are joined by “and,” a plural verb is used.

Example:

Ravi and Sita **are** *friends.*

LONG ANSWERS

1. “When the subject is separated from the verb by a phrase, the verb still agrees with the subject, not the noun in the phrase.”

Explain this rule with examples.

In English grammar, the **verb must always agree with the main subject**, even if another noun comes between them. Sometimes a **phrase** (often a prepositional phrase or modifying phrase) separates the subject and verb.

A common mistake is to match the verb with the **nearest noun** instead of the **real subject**.

Rule:

Identify the **true subject** before the phrase; the verb must match that subject.

Examples:

The bouquet of flowers *is* beautiful.

Subject: *bouquet* (singular)

“of flowers” is only a phrase → verb should be singular (*is*), not plural.

The quality of the products *has* improved.

Subject: *quality* (singular)

“of the products” does not affect agreement.

The students in the class *are* hardworking.

Subject: *students* (plural)

Verb must be plural (*are*), not singular.

My friend with many dogs *is* here.

Subject: *friend* (singular)

Conclusion: Always locate the **main subject** and ignore the nouns inside phrases while choosing the correct verb.

2. Discuss the difference between prepositional phrases and adverbial phrases.

Prepositional Phrase

Begins with a **preposition** (in, on, at, under, before, between, etc.)

Ends with the **object of the preposition**.

Functions as an **adjective** or **adverb**.

Example:

*The book is **on the table**.* (shows location)

Adverbial Phrase

A group of words acting like an **adverb**, giving information about **time, place, manner, reason, degree**, etc.

It may or may not contain a preposition.

Examples:

*She spoke **with great confidence** (manner)*

*He will return **in the morning** (time → also a prepositional phrase functioning as an adverb)*

Difference:

Feature	Prepositional Phrase	Adverbial Phrase
Beginning	Always starts with a preposition	May or may not start with a preposition
Function	Can act as adjective or adverb	Only acts as adverb
Example	<i>under the tree</i>	<i>with great care, very quickly</i>

Conclusion: All prepositional phrases that modify verbs become adverbial phrases, but not all adverbial phrases are prepositional.

3. Illustrate the difference between coordinating, subordinating, and correlative conjunctions with examples.

1. Coordinating Conjunctions

Join **equal grammatical units**: words, phrases, or independent clauses.
Common conjunctions: **FANBOYS** (for, and, nor, but, or, yet, so)

Example:

*I wanted to go out, **but** it started raining.*

2. Subordinating Conjunctions

Join an **independent clause** with a **dependent clause**.
Examples: *because, although, since, if, when, unless*

Example:

*She left early **because** she was feeling sick.*

3. Correlative Conjunctions

Paired conjunctions used together.
Examples: **either...or, neither...nor, both...and, not only...but also**

Example:

*I will **either** call you **or** meet you later.*

Difference Summary:

Coordinating → equal units

Subordinating → dependent + independent clause

Correlative → paired link between similar structures

4. Write five well-constructed sentences using different sentence types.

Affirmative:

She completed her assignment on time

Negative:

He does not like spicy food.

Interrogative:

Did you finish the project?

Imperative:

Please close the door.

Exclamatory:

What a beautiful view this is!

5. Write a letter to Principal asking two days' leave for your sister's marriage.

To

The Principal

[Name of College/School]

[City]

Subject: Request for Two Days' Leave

Respected Sir/Madam

I am a student of Class/Year _____, Roll No. _____. I request you to kindly grant me **two days' leave**, from **(date)** to **(date)**, as I have to attend my sister's marriage at my native place. My presence at home is essential for the family function.

I assure you that I will complete all pending work after returning to class.

Kindly consider my request.

Thanking you

Yours obediently,

[Your Name]

Class: _____

Roll No: _____

6. Discuss the role of transitive and intransitive verbs in sentence construction. Provide examples showing how the same verb can be both transitive and intransitive.

Transitive Verbs

Require an **object** to complete meaning.

Answer “*what?*” or “*whom?*”

Example:

She wrote a letter.

Intransitive Verbs

Do **not** require an object.

Meaning is complete without an object.

Example:

She wrote for two hours.

Same verb used as both:

Run

Transitive: *He ran a company.*

Intransitive: *He ran fast.*

Break

Transitive: *She broke the glass.*

Intransitive: *The glass broke.*

Read

Transitive: *She read the book.*

Intransitive: *She reads every night.*

This flexibility enhances sentence variety and clarity.

7. Explain subject–verb agreement in detail. Describe rules related to number, person, and special cases such as collective nouns and indefinite pronouns.

Subject–verb agreement ensures **grammatical correctness** and **clear communication**.

A. Agreement of Number

Singular subject → singular verb

*The girl **sings**.*

Plural subject → plural verb

*The girls **sing**.*

B. Agreement of Person

First person: *I am, We are*

Second person: *You are*

Third person: *He/She/It is, They are*

C. Special Cases

Collective Nouns

Singular when the group acts as one unit:

*The team **wins** every match.*

Plural when members act individually:

*The team **are** arguing among themselves.*

Indefinite Pronouns

Singular: *Each, everyone, someone, anyone*

*Each of them **is** ready.*

Plural: *Both, few, many, several*

*Many **are** absent.*

Subjects joined by “and” → plural

*Rita and Sita **are** friends.*

Subjects joined by “or/nor” → verb agrees with closest subject

*Neither the students nor the teacher **is** here.*

8. Discuss common errors made by learners in India regarding regular and irregular verbs. Provide examples of incorrect and correct usage.

Typical Errors

Adding “-ed” to irregular verbs

Incorrect: *He **comed** yesterday.*

Correct: *He **came** yesterday.*

Using base form instead of past form

Incorrect: *She **go** to market yesterday.*

Correct: *She **went** to market yesterday.*

Confusing past participle with simple past

Incorrect: *I have **ate** food.*

Correct: *I have **eaten** food.*

Using incorrect verb patterns

Incorrect: *He has **did** it.*

Correct: *He has **done** it.*

Overusing “did” in past affirmative sentences

Incorrect: *He **did** went.*

Correct: *He **went**.*

9. Describe how verbs change according to tense. Explain how verb forms are used in simple, continuous, perfect, and perfect continuous tenses.

1. Simple Tenses

Show general actions or completed actions.

Forms: base form / past form / will + base form

I ate.

I will eat.

2. Continuous (Progressive) Tenses

Show ongoing action.

Form: be (am/is/are/was/were) + verb + **-ing**

She is reading.

She was reading.

3. Perfect Tenses

Show completed action with relevance to another time.

Form: have/has/had + **past participle**

He has written a letter.

He had written before leaving.

4. Perfect Continuous Tenses

Show action that began in the past and continues.

Form: have/has been + **verb-ing**

They have been studying for two hours.

She had been waiting since morning.

10. Explain the importance of subject–verb agreement in writing and communication. Provide examples showing how incorrect agreement affects clarity and correctness.

Subject–verb agreement is essential for:

1. Grammatical Accuracy

Incorrect: He go to school.

Correct: He goes to school.

2. Clarity of Meaning

Incorrect: The list of items are on the table.

– Confusing

Correct: The list of items is on the table.

3. Professional and Academic Writing

Proper agreement reflects competence.

Incorrect: The results of the survey was surprising.

Correct: The results of the survey were surprising.

4. Reader Understanding

Correct agreement ensures the subject and verb form match logically, improving readability.

UNIT-4

SHORT ANSWERS

1. Explain the difference between transitive and intransitive verbs with examples.

Transitive verb: A verb that needs an object to complete its meaning.

Example: She **writes** (verb) a **letter** (object).

Intransitive verb: A verb that does not need an object.

Example: The baby **cried**.

2. How can complex sentence structures improve academic and narrative writing?

Complex sentences help show relationships between ideas, add clarity, and make writing more logical and detailed. They improve flow and make arguments stronger in academic and narrative writing.

3. Define a correlative conjunction and give two examples.

A **correlative conjunction** is a pair of conjunctions used together to join equal parts of a sentence.

Examples: *either...or, both...and.*

4. Define simple present tense and give one example.

The **simple present tense** expresses daily routines, facts, and general truths.

Example: She **goes** to school every day.

5. What is a sentence? Write the types of sentences.

A **sentence** is a group of words that expresses a complete thought.

Types:

Declarative

Interrogative

Imperative

Exclamatory

6. Write two examples of prepositions that indicate time.

At, on

- 1. She is waiting at bus stop**
- 2. The cat is sitting on the table.**

7. Give two coordinating conjunctions used to connect ideas.

And, but

- 1. Radha and Geetha are true friends.**
- 2. He is poor but honest.**

8. Write one contraction each for *will not* and *I am*.

will not → **won't**

I am → **I'm**

LONG ANSWERS

1. Write a short paragraph (5–6 sentences) demonstrating correct subject–verb agreement. Underline each subject and circle each verb.

(I cannot underline or circle directly in chat, so I mark them like this:

Subject = [S], Verb = (V).)

Paragraph:

[S] The teacher (V) *explains* the topic clearly every day. **[S] The students** (V) *listen* carefully and (V) *take* notes. **[S] Each lesson** (V) *helps* them understand the subject better. **[S] The classroom** always (V) *remains* quiet during discussions. **[S] Everyone** (V) *learns* something new by the end of the day.

2. Analyze how overuse of contractions can affect academic or formal writing style.

Overusing contractions can make academic writing sound informal and less professional. Contractions such as *don't*, *can't*, and *I'm* are suitable for speech and casual writing but may weaken the seriousness of formal work. In academic contexts, clarity and precision are important, and full forms appear more polished. Excessive use of contractions can also reduce readability for international readers. Therefore, contractions should be used carefully in formal writing.

3. Write five sentences using different interjections to express joy, sorrow, anger, and surprise.

Hurrah! We won the match. (Joy)

Alas! The old man passed away. (Sorrow)

Oh no! I lost my wallet. (Sorrow/Surprise)

Wow! That's an amazing painting. (Surprise)

Hey! Stop shouting at me. (Anger)

4. Write a conversation between two friends — one describing today's routine and the other recalling yesterday's events.

Friend A: Hey, today I **wake up** early and **go** for a walk.

Friend B: Nice! Yesterday I **woke up** late because I was tired.

Friend A: After breakfast, I **attend** my classes online.

Friend B: Yesterday I **missed** my first class but later I **completed** all assignments.

Friend A: Today I also **plan** to study in the evening.

5. What is a phrase and its types? Explain in detail.

A **phrase** is a group of words without a subject–verb combination, and it does not express a complete thought.

Types:

Noun Phrase – acts as a noun. (e.g., *a tall boy*)

Verb Phrase – verb + helping verbs. (e.g., *is running*)

Adjective Phrase – describes a noun. (e.g., *full of joy*)

Adverb Phrase – describes a verb. (e.g., *in the morning*)

Prepositional Phrase – begins with a preposition. (e.g., *on the table*)

6. Discuss the structure of wh-questions and yes/no questions. Explain how word order changes when forming questions. Provide examples.

Structure:

WH-questions: WH-word + helping verb + subject + main verb

Example: *Where are you going?*

Yes/No questions: Helping verb + subject + main verb

Example: *Do you like tea?*

Word order changes from:

Statement: *You are going home.*

Question: *Are you going home?*

The helping verb moves before the subject.

7. Explain contractions in English. Discuss their usage in spoken and informal written communication with examples of common contractions.

Contractions are shortened forms of words created by combining words and using an apostrophe.

Examples: *don't, can't, isn't, I'm, it's.*

They are used in **spoken English** and **informal writing** because they make language natural and conversational. However, they are usually avoided in academic and professional writing.

8. Write a detailed note on differences between contractions and short forms. Explain situations where contractions should be avoided.

Contractions combine two words using an apostrophe.

Example: *I'm* (I am), *let's* (let us), *can't* (cannot).

Short forms may be abbreviations or shortened versions without apostrophes.

Example: *info* (information), *exam* (examination).

Avoid contractions in:

Academic writing

Job applications

Official letters

Reports and research papers

They make the writing appear informal.

9. Discuss interjections and their importance in expressing emotions. Provide examples.

Interjections are words used to express sudden feelings or emotions. They add emotional force, tone, and spontaneity to speech or writing. Examples:

Surprise: *Wow!*

Joy: *Hurrah!*

Anger: *Ugh!*

Pain: *Ouch!*

10. Explain common mistakes made by learners when using prepositions, conjunctions, question words, contractions, and interjections. Give corrected examples.

Common mistakes:

Prepositions:

✗ *He goes in school.*

✓ *He goes to school.*

Conjunctions:

✗ *I like tea and not coffee.*

✓ *I like tea but not coffee.*

Question words:

✗ *Where you are going?*

✓ *Where are you going?*

Contractions:

✗ *Its a good idea.*

✓ *It's a good idea.*

Interjections:

✗ *Wow that is great.* (missing punctuation)

✓ *Wow! That is great.*

UNIT-5

SHORT ANSWERS

1. Discuss common errors in subject–verb agreement made by Indian learners of English.

Common errors include:

Using plural verbs with singular subjects

✗ *She go to school.*

✓ *She goes to school.*

Confusion with “each,” “everyone,” “everyone” (treated as singular)

✗ *Everyone know the answer.*

✓ *Everyone knows the answer.*

Errors with compound subjects joined by **and/or**

✗ *Ram and Shyam is coming.*

✓ *Ram and Shyam are coming.*

Errors with collective nouns

✗ *The team are playing well.* (Indian speakers often use plural)

✓ *The team is playing well.*

Confusion with distance/money/weights

✓ *Five hundred rupees is enough.*

2. Discuss the functions and types of prepositions with examples.

Functions:

Show **time** (at, on, in)

Show **place** (under, near, beside)

Show **direction** (to, towards, into)

Show **method/agent** (by, with)

Types:

Prepositions of **time**: *at 5 pm, on Sunday*

Prepositions of **place**: *under the table*

Prepositions of **direction**: *go to school*

Prepositions of **manner**: *with courage*

Prepositions of **agent**: *by the teacher*

3. Differentiate between coordinating and subordinating conjunctions.

Coordinating Conjunctions	Subordinating Conjunctions
Join equal ideas	Join dependent idea to main idea
FANBOYS (for, and, nor, but, or, yet, so)	because, although, since, when, if
Example: <i>I tried but failed.</i>	Example: <i>I failed because I was tired.</i>

4. Name the four types of sentences based on function.

Declarative

Interrogative

Imperative

Exclamatory

5. Give any five examples of Simple Past tense.

She **went** to school.

I **played** cricket yesterday.

They **visited** the museum.

He **ate** an apple.

We **watched** a movie.

6. How do we describe current happenings? Name the tense used.

We describe current happenings using the **Present Continuous Tense**.

Example: She is writing now.

7. Give one example of a command and one example of a suggestion.

Command: *Close the door.*

Suggestion: *You should drink more water.*

8. Write one sentence each that shows a simple present scenario and a simple past scenario.

Simple Present: She **reads** every day.

Simple Past: She **read** a book yesterday.

LONG ANSWERS

1. Examine how compound subjects affect subject–verb agreement. Provide examples.

A **compound subject** contains two or more nouns or pronouns joined by conjunctions.
Rules:

Joined by AND → Plural verb

*Ram and Shyam **are** friends.*

Joined by AND but referring to one idea → Singular verb

*Bread and butter **is** my breakfast.*

Joined by OR / NOR → Verb agrees with the nearest subject

*Either the teacher or the students **are** responsible.*

*Either the students or the teacher **is** responsible.*

Compound subjects require careful attention to agreement to maintain grammatical accuracy.

2. Differentiate between compound and complex sentences with examples.

Compound Sentence

Has **two independent clauses**

Joined by FANBOYS

Example: *I was tired, but I finished the work.*

Complex Sentence

Has **one independent + one dependent clause**

Joined by subordinators (because, although, when)

Example: *I finished the work because I was tired.*

3. Analyze the role of prepositions in sentence coherence and meaning.

Prepositions help:

Show **time, place, direction**, and logical relationships

Link words, making sentences meaningful

Avoid ambiguity

Examples:

*He sat **on** the chair.* (place)

*She came **at** 5 pm.* (time)

*They walked **towards** the river.* (direction)

Prepositions create smooth transitions and strengthen sentence coherence.

4. Write a short paragraph describing your school life then and now (past vs. present).

In my childhood, I **studied** in a small school near my village. I **had** many friends, and we **played** together during the lunch break. Now, I **study** in a larger institution with modern facilities. I **attend** regular classes and **participate** in various activities. My school life has changed, but I still **enjoy** learning every day.

5. Write a letter to Principal requesting her to issue Bonafide Certificate for higher studies.

To

The Principal

_____ College

_____ (City)

Subject: Request for Bonafide Certificate

Respected Madam,

I, _____ (your name), a student of _____ (class/department), request you to kindly issue me a Bonafide Certificate. I need the certificate for my higher studies admission process. Kindly issue it at the earliest.

Thanking you.

Yours sincerely,

6. Describe how to express the current status of happenings. Explain the present continuous tense and state verbs.

We express current happenings using the **Present Continuous Tense**:

Structure: *Subject + is/am/are + verb+ing*

Example: *She is studying now.*

State verbs describe feelings, possession, or mental states and are **not normally used in -ing form**.

Examples: *know, believe, love, have (possession)*

✓ *I know the answer.* (not *I am knowing*)

Present continuous describes actions happening *now*, while state verbs describe *conditions*.

7. Discuss the language structure of commands, comments, and suggestions.

Commands:

Use **imperative** form (verb without subject)

Example: *Sit down.*

Comments:

Use simple present or present continuous

Example: *You speak very well.*

Suggestions:

Use modals: **should, could, may**

Example: *You should take rest.*

Commands require direct verbs; suggestions use modals; comments describe observations.

8. Explain how to identify and use simple present scenarios.

Simple Present is used for:

Daily routines – *She goes to school.*

Universal truths – *The sun rises in the east.*

Schedules/timetables – *The train leaves at 7 pm.*

States – *I live in Odisha.*

Identify by: **habit, truth, regularity, or fixed schedule.**

9. Explain how to identify and describe simple past scenarios.

Simple Past expresses **completed actions**:

Structure: *Subject + past verb*

Examples:

She **visited** her uncle yesterday.

They **studied** last night.

Time markers: yesterday, last week, in 2020, ago.

Simple past is used in **stories**, **narratives**, and **historical events**.

10. Discuss common errors made by learners in:

a) Differentiating time periods

✗ *I am going yesterday.*

✓ *I went yesterday.*

b) States vs. Processes

✗ *I am knowing the answer.*

✓ *I know the answer.*

c) Expressing possession

✗ *She is having a car.*

✓ *She has a car.*

d) Forming simple present/past sentences

✗ *He go to school.*

✓ *He goes to school.*

✗ *She eat yesterday.*

✓ *She ate yesterday.*